

Word family: ****apologise / apologize / apologised / apologized / apologising / apologizing / apology / apologetic / apologetically****

****Base word:**** apologise / apologize

****Part of speech:**** mainly ****verb****

****BrE spelling:**** ****apologise****

****AmE spelling:**** ****apologize****

****Related forms:****

* ****apologise / apologize**** (v.) — 道歉

* ****apology**** (n.) — 道歉；歉意

* ****apologetic**** (adj.) — 帶歉意的；覺得抱歉的

* ****apologetically**** (adv.) — 帶歉意地

* ****unapologetic**** (adj.) — 不覺得需要道歉的；毫無歉意的

* ****unapologetically**** (adv.) — 毫無歉意地

****Useful expressions / extensions:****

* ****apologise to someone****

* ****apologise for something****

* ****apologise for doing something****

* ****apologise to someone for something****

* ****apologise properly****

* ****apologise sincerely****

* ****owe someone an apology****

* ****make an apology****

* ****offer an apology****

* ****accept an apology****

* ****a sincere / genuine apology****

* ****a public apology****

* ****an apology for something****

* ****be apologetic about****

* ****sound apologetic****

* ****unapologetic about****

Meaning in this passage

> One time someone ****apologised to me**** that I remember very clearly happened in my final year at university.

and later:

> The next day, before class started, he came over to me and ****apologised properly****.

Here, ****apologised**** means:

****said that he was sorry and accepted that he had done something wrong — 道歉；認錯並表示歉意****

Kevin had wrongly blamed the speaker in front of the group. Later, after realizing his mistake, he admitted it and apologized directly.

****中文翻譯：****

第二天上課前，他主動走過來，很認真地向我****道歉****。

So here:

****apologise = 因自己做錯、傷害或冒犯了別人，而向對方表示歉意****

1. ****apologise to someone — 向某人道歉****

This is the core pattern used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Kevin ****apologised to me**** the next day.

Kevin 第二天向我****道歉****。

Practice 2

> You should ****apologise to her****.

你應該向她****道歉****。

Practice 3

> He finally ****apologised to his teammate****.

他終於向隊友****道歉****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****apologise to someone = 因自己的錯誤、行為或說話而向某人表示歉意****

2. ****apologise for something — 為某事道歉****

Practice 1

> He ****apologised for his behaviour****.

他為自己的行為****道歉****。

Practice 2

> She ****apologised for the delay****.

她為延誤****道歉****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****apologise for X = 因 X 是自己造成的錯誤、問題或冒犯而表示歉意****

3. ****apologise for doing something — 為做了某事而道歉****

Practice 1

> He ****apologised for embarrassing me**** in front of the group.

他為當眾令我難堪而****道歉****。

Practice 2

> She ****apologised for arriving late****.

她為遲到而****道歉****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****apologise for doing X = 為自己做了 X 而表示歉意****

4. ****apologise to someone for something — 因某事向某人道歉****

The full and most precise structure.

Practice 1

> Kevin ****apologised to me for blaming me unfairly****.

Kevin 因為不公平地怪責我而向我**道歉**。

Practice 2

> I **apologised to my teacher for missing the class**.

我因為缺席課堂而向老師**道歉**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****apologise to A for B = 因 B 這件事向 A 表示歉意****

5. **apologise properly — 好好 / 認真道歉**

This is directly used in your passage.

Practice 1

> He came over and **apologised properly**.

他走過來，很認真地**好好道歉**。

Practice 2

> If you hurt someone, you should **apologise properly**.

如果你傷害了別人，就應該**認真道歉**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****apologise properly = 不敷衍地，而是真誠、清楚地承認錯誤並表示歉意****

6. **apologise sincerely / genuinely — 真誠道歉**

Practice 1

> She **apologised sincerely** for what she had said.

她為自己說過的話**真誠道歉**。

Practice 2

> He **genuinely apologised** and accepted responsibility.

他**真心道歉**，並承擔責任。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****apologise sincerely/genuinely = 真心表示歉意，而不是只做表面功夫****

7. ****apologise publicly — 公開道歉****

Practice 1

> The company ****apologised publicly**** for the mistake.

公司為錯誤****公開道歉****。

Practice 2

> He chose to ****apologise publicly**** because the criticism had also been public.

由於之前的批評也是公開的，他選擇****公開道歉****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****apologise publicly = 在公眾、群體或公開平台面前表示歉意****

8. ****apologise in person — 親自道歉****

Practice 1

> He came to ****apologise in person****.

他親自前來****道歉****。

Practice 2

> She felt that a text message was not enough, so she ****apologised in person****.

她覺得只傳短訊不夠，所以親自****道歉****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****apologise in person = 面對面親自向對方表示歉意****

9. **apology** (道歉 ; 歉意) — 道歉

The core noun form.

Practice 1

> His **apology** sounded sincere.

他的**道歉**聽起來很真誠。

Practice 2

> I accepted his **apology**.

我接受了他的**道歉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

apology = 因為做錯、傷害或冒犯別人而表達的歉意或道歉說話

10. **make an apology** — 作出道歉

Practice 1

> He **made an apology** to the whole group.

他向整個小組**作出道歉**。

Practice 2

> The manager **made a formal apology**.

經理**正式道歉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

make an apology = 正式或明確地表達歉意

Usage note: In everyday English, **apologise** is often more natural than **make an apology**.

11. **offer an apology** — 表示 / 提出道歉

More formal.

Practice 1

> The company **offered an apology** to customers.

公司向顧客**表示歉意**。

Practice 2

> He **offered a sincere apology**.

他作出了**真誠的道歉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

offer an apology = formal: 向對方表達道歉或歉意

12. **owe someone an apology — 欠某人一句道歉；應該向某人道歉**

A very useful expression.

Practice 1

> You **owe her an apology**.

你**應該向她道歉**。

Practice 2

> Kevin realized that he **owed me an apology**.

Kevin 意識到自己**欠我一句道歉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

owe someone an apology = 因為自己做錯事，所以有責任向某人道歉

13. **accept an apology — 接受道歉**

Practice 1

> I **accepted his apology**.

我**接受了他的道歉**。

Practice 2

> She wasn't ready to **accept the apology** immediately.

她當時還未準備好立即**接受道歉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

accept an apology = 表示願意接納對方的歉意，通常不再追究同一件事

14. **reject / refuse an apology** — 不接受道歉

Practice 1

> She **refused his apology** because she felt it was insincere.

她覺得他的道歉不真誠，所以**不接受**。

Practice 2

> He **rejected the apology**.

他**拒絕接受道歉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reject/refuse an apology = 不接納對方的道歉或歉意

15. **sincere / genuine apology** — 真誠道歉

Very relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> It felt like a **genuine apology**.

那感覺是一個**真誠的道歉**。

Practice 2

> A **sincere apology** can repair trust.

真誠的道歉可以修復信任。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sincere/genuine apology = 真心承認錯誤並表示後悔，而不是只為形式而道歉****

16. ****public apology — 公開道歉****

Practice 1

> The organization issued a ****public apology****.

該機構作出了****公開道歉****。

Practice 2

> He made a ****public apology**** for his comments.

他為自己的言論作出****公開道歉****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****public apology = 向公眾或一大群人公開作出的道歉****

17. ****formal apology — 正式道歉****

Practice 1

> The school sent a ****formal apology**** to the family.

學校向該家庭發出****正式道歉****。

Practice 2

> She requested a ****formal apology****.

她要求對方作出****正式道歉****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****formal apology = 以正式方式作出的道歉，常見於機構、工作或官方場合****

18. ****written apology — 書面道歉****

Practice 1

> He submitted a **written apology**.

他提交了一份**書面道歉**。

Practice 2

> The company sent a **written apology** by email.

公司透過電郵發出**書面道歉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

written apology = 以文字形式表達的道歉

19. **apology for something** — 因某事作出的道歉

Practice 1

> His **apology for the mistake** was sincere.

他為那個錯誤所作的**道歉**很真誠。

Practice 2

> We received an **apology for the delay**.

我們收到對方就延誤作出的**歉意**。

MCQ-ready definition:

an apology for X = 因 X 而作出的道歉

20. **apology to someone** — 向某人的道歉

Practice 1

> He offered an **apology to the whole team**.

他向整個團隊**道歉**。

Practice 2

> The statement included an **apology to customers**.

聲明中包括向顧客作出的**道歉**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****an apology to someone = 向某個人或群體表達的歉意****

21. ****apologetic — 抱歉的；帶有歉意的****

Practice 1

> He looked genuinely ****apologetic****.

他看起來真的很****抱歉****。

Practice 2

> She gave me an ****apologetic smile****.

她向我露出一個****帶歉意的微笑****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****apologetic = 顯示自己感到抱歉、後悔或不好意思的****

22. ****sound / look apologetic — 聽起來 / 看起來很抱歉****

Practice 1

> He sounded ****apologetic**** on the phone.

他在電話裏聽起來很****抱歉****。

Practice 2

> She looked ****apologetic**** after realizing her mistake.

她意識到錯誤後看起來很****有歉意****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****look/sound apologetic = 表情或語氣顯示出歉意****

23. **apologetically** — 帶歉意地

Practice 1

> "I'm sorry," he said **apologetically**.

「對不起。」他帶着歉意地說。

Practice 2

> She smiled **apologetically**.

她抱歉地笑了一下。

MCQ-ready definition:

apologetically = 以顯示歉意或不好意思的方式

24. **unapologetic** — 毫無歉意的；不覺得需要道歉的

A useful opposite.

Practice 1

> He was completely **unapologetic** about his decision.

他對自己的決定毫無歉意。

Practice 2

> She remained **unapologetic** despite the criticism.

儘管受到批評，她仍然沒有覺得自己需要道歉。

MCQ-ready definition:

unapologetic = 不因自己的行為、觀點或選擇而感到需要道歉

25. **unapologetically** — 毫無歉意地；坦然地

Practice 1

> She is **unapologetically** ambitious.

她**毫不掩飾、也不覺得需要為此道歉地**展現自己的野心。

Practice 2

> The design is **unapologetically** bold.

這個設計**毫不收斂地**大膽。

MCQ-ready definition:

unapologetically = 不覺得需要因某種特質、選擇或立場而道歉地

This often carries a positive “毫不掩飾 / 坦然” nuance rather than literal apology.

26. **“Sorry” vs apologise — 說「對不起」 vs 正式 / 明確道歉**

Practice 1

> He said **sorry**, but he never really **apologised**.

他說了「對不起」，但其實從未真正**好好道歉**。

Practice 2

> A real apology often involves more than simply saying **sorry**.

真正的道歉往往不只是說一句**對不起**。

MCQ-ready definition:

apologise = the act of expressing regret; saying “sorry” is one common way of doing it

27. **apologise for inconvenience — 為造成不便致歉**

A very common service/business formula.

Practice 1

> We **apologise for the inconvenience**.

對造成的不便，我們**深表歉意**。

Practice 2

> The airline **apologised** for any inconvenience caused.

航空公司就造成的任何不便**致歉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

apologise for the inconvenience = 商業或服務場合中，因造成麻煩、不便或延誤而正式表示歉意

28. **apologise for interrupting / bothering** — 為打擾道歉

Practice 1

> I **apologise for interrupting**.

很抱歉**打斷你**。

Practice 2

> She **apologised for bothering him** so late.

她為這麼晚**打擾他**而道歉。

MCQ-ready definition:

apologise for interrupting/bothering = 因打擾、打斷或造成不便而表示歉意

Important distinction 1: **apologise vs say sorry**

say sorry

everyday wording.

apologise

describes the act more generally and can sound slightly more formal.

> I said sorry.

我說了對不起。

> I apologised.

我道歉了。

Both are natural.

Important distinction 2: **apologise to vs apologise for**

This grammar distinction is essential.

Person:

> apologise **to Kevin**

向 Kevin 道歉

Reason:

> apologise **for the mistake**

為錯誤道歉

Both:

> apologise **to Kevin for the mistake**

因錯誤向 Kevin 道歉

Important distinction 3: **apologise for doing vs apologise to do**

Normally:

> apologise **for being late** 

not:

> *apologise to be late* 

But:

> I apologise **to say that...**

can occur in very formal/old-fashioned wording, though learners generally do not need it.

For normal use:

apologise for + noun / -ing

Important distinction 4: **apologise vs regret**

apologise

communicate your apology to someone.

regret

feel sorry about something internally.

> I regret what I did.

我後悔自己的行為。

> I apologised for what I did.

我為自己的行為向對方道歉。

You can regret something without apologising.

Important distinction 5: **apology vs excuse**

Very important for your passage.

apology

admits regret.

excuse

gives a reason or justification.

> I'm sorry I blamed you unfairly.

apology

> I was stressed, so that's why I did it.

explanation/excuse

Kevin's apology matters because he **did not hide behind excuses**.

Important distinction 6: **apology vs explanation**

apology

expresses regret and usually accepts some responsibility.

explanation

explains why something happened.

A good apology may include an explanation, but an explanation is not automatically an apology.

Important distinction 7: **apology vs admission**

admission

acknowledges that something is true.

apology

expresses regret.

> He admitted he was wrong.

他承認自己錯。

> He apologised for being wrong.

他為自己的錯誤道歉。

In your passage, Kevin does both.

Important distinction 8: **apologetic vs sorry**

sorry

can describe actual regret:

> I'm sorry.

apologetic

usually describes manner/appearance:

> an apologetic smile

帶歉意的笑容

Apologetic often means someone **looks or sounds sorry**.

Important distinction 9: **sincere apology vs performative apology**

sincere apology

genuine regret.

performative / insincere apology

said mainly for appearance, pressure, or damage control.

Your passage strongly emphasizes that Kevin's apology was **sincere**, because he admitted what he had done and understood why it hurt.

Important distinction 10: **public apology vs private apology**

public apology

made openly before others.

private apology

made directly and privately to the affected person.

In your passage, the original criticism was public, while Kevin later came over personally to apologize.

Important distinction 11: **accept an apology vs forgive someone**

These overlap but are not identical.

accept an apology

acknowledge and receive the apology.

forgive someone

let go of blame or resentment.

You can accept an apology but still need time before fully forgiving.

Important distinction 12: **owe someone an apology**

This is figurative **owe**:

> You owe me an apology.

does not mean financial debt.

It means:

because of what you did, you have a moral responsibility to apologize

Important distinction 13: **unapologetic does not always mean rude**

Depending on context:

> unapologetically ambitious

can mean:

坦然有野心，不覺得自己需要為此感到抱歉

It can be positive, neutral, or critical depending on what follows.

Family-extension note

Apologise has one central semantic core:

acknowledge that something you did caused harm, offence, inconvenience, or difficulty, and express regret

The family then spreads into:

1. **verb patterns**

- * apologise to someone
- * apologise for something
- * apologise for doing something

2. **noun**

- * apology
- * sincere apology
- * public apology

3. **manner/state**

- * apologetic
- * apologetically

4. **opposite stance**

- * unapologetic
- * unapologetically

For your passage, the most important distinction is:

real apology = not merely saying “sorry,” but acknowledging the specific wrongdoing

Kevin did that by:

- * admitting he had jumped to conclusions,
- * acknowledging that stress affected him,
- * apologising for embarrassing the speaker publicly.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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apologise	道歉	express regret	
apologise to someone	向某人道歉	person affected	

apologise for X	為 X 道歉	reason	
apologise for doing X	為做了 X 道歉	action	
apologise to A for B	因 B 向 A 道歉	full pattern	
apologise properly	認真道歉	genuine/full apology	
apologise sincerely	真誠道歉	genuine regret	
apologise publicly	公開道歉	public setting	
apologise in person	親自道歉	face-to-face	
apology	道歉；歉意	noun	
make an apology	作出道歉	explicit apology	
offer an apology	表示歉意	formal	
owe someone an apology	應向某人道歉	moral obligation	
accept an apology	接受道歉	receive apology	
sincere apology	真誠道歉	genuine	
public apology	公開道歉	public	
formal apology	正式道歉	official	
written apology	書面道歉	written	
apologetic	抱歉的；帶歉意的	showing regret	
apologetic smile	帶歉意的微笑	apologetic manner	
apologetically	帶歉意地	manner	
unapologetic	毫無歉意的	no regret	
unapologetically	毫無歉意地 / 坦然地	openly without apology	

For your original passage

> The next day, before class started, he came over to me and **apologised properly**.

Here:

apologised properly = 不只是隨口說一句 sorry，而是認真承認錯誤並清楚說明自己為甚麼道歉**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 第二天上課前，他主動走過來，很認真地向我**道歉**。

And the full structure later is essentially:

> He **apologised to me for embarrassing me in front of the group**.

=

> 他為自己當着全組人的面令我難堪而向我**道歉**。

For this passage, the emotional force comes from the fact that the apology is ****specific, sincere, and responsibility-taking****, rather than defensive or excuse-making.